

EXPORT · THEMING · #1527

The palette wins the cascade

Every surface on this deck is painted from a token the exported PDF used to ignore.

THE ONE-LINE CHANGE

The engine sheet loads first, the palette last.

- The order every theme declares
 - Each `themes/*.css` opens with `@import 'lattice';`, which means the engine's rules come first and the theme's own win at equal specificity.
- The order three of four sites already used
 - The Mermaid token reader, `engine.addThemes` and the Studio's composed sheet. Only the export bundle disagreed.
- What that cost
 - 925 declarations across 37 tokens, on all 32 palettes, resolved to the engine's value. A deck looked one way in the Playground and another in the PDF.

Render this deck at any palette: what you see is what that palette's author wrote.

Each palette's own syntax ramp paints now.

```
// Before the flip: Night Owl's purple and pink on every theme. Now: whatever  
// ramp the chosen palette curated for its own code panel.  
const ENGINE = readFileSync('dist/lattice.css', 'utf8');  
const PALETTE = themeChain(name).map(readTheme).join('\n');  
  
function deckStylesheet() {  
  // Parent first, engine first: a palette ':root' then beats the base's at  
  // equal specificity – which is what `@import 'lattice';` meant all along.  
  return `${ENGINE}\n${PALETTE}\n/* lattice:palette-end */`;  
}  
  
export const cascade = deckStylesheet(); // one order, every render path
```

Try `cuoio` for warm terracotta and amber, `ardesia` for muted slate and teal.

The status trio comes from the palette, not the engine.

✓ Done rows take the palette's own pass ink

— Partial rows take its warn ink

amber

○ Open rows keep the neutral ring

✓ An achromatopsia palette paints three grays

✎ ~~Descoped rows stay struck and muted~~

— Three signals, three weights, one palette

On `ally-achromatopsia` these were engine green and amber — one gray to the reader they are for.

2026 Q1 .. 2026 Q4 today Q3

Plan bars take their status tints from the palette.

Nine of these tokens used to resolve two ways in one render — the baked SVG from the palette, the CSS around it from the engine.



The struck clause sits on a tint of the palette's own red.

lattice-emulator.js:847 · #1527

The deck stylesheet is assembled as ~~the palette then the engine bundle~~ the engine bundle then the palette, so a token the palette declares at `:root` ~~loses to the engine default~~ wins at equal specificity. A palette's syntax ramp, status trio and diagram state family therefore ~~resolve to the engine's value on the export path while the Playground shows the palette's~~ resolve the same way everywhere, and the nine tokens read by both the stylesheet and the Mermaid token map ~~can no longer~~ no longer paint a bar and the rule beside it from one name and two values.

Why this matters. The ink and the band behind it both move with the token, so this surface is where a palette's status hue is hardest to read — and where the sweep found the numbers that mattered.

Same deck, same palette, one cascade

One order · every render path

Preview and export finally agree.